

CSC 591 Puzzle Room Reflection

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This project certainly had fewer realizations to be made than the previous ones. By the beginning of this project, I was already familiar with Unity and was even able to reuse some assets from the previous game. This allowed for a more streamlined developmental process—especially for my tasks, which primarily revolved around map, prop/asset, and music design. That being said, there was still plenty of room for improvement regarding the general workflow in a collaborative setting.

I faced fewer challenges in this project than in the last one. For the Dungeon Crawler I developed a procedural generation algorithm that took several days to fully implement, and that had many learning curves I had to face, especially with learning Unity for the first time. For this one, I simply implemented the metamorphosis through a dynamic room schema where the environment morphed as more puzzles were completed. I also learned a bit more about prop development and creating cool-looking furniture items instead of just simply the map.

Our group continued to face issues as a result of poor planning among the groupmates. Only one other person and I were consistently working towards the project, and the other two crammed all their work in together just before the due date. This did result in a somewhat janky final deliverable, and in the future, I hope we can come to a better workflow amongst each other and come to create a better final product that really, truly showcases what we are actually capable of creating.

The metamorphosis elements in both projects were also very similar. We focused on the level itself changing in some way as the game progressed, and we used narrative aspects from the dialogue to explore the metamorphosis of not just the character's environment but also their mental/physical state.

The project overall helped to develop the story and went along with what we had planned eventually. The final quality was less than I would have liked, but for what we developed, it was definitely still a success. Our last game may be one of the hardest to work on with the constraints of upcoming exams, but simultaneously, that may be liberating and allow us to work even harder on it or something. I have high aspirations, and hope that we can really come together and explore our actual talents within this narrative game development, and make an excellent final project.